CS-012 Purchasing & Reimbursement

Doc ID	CS-012
Title	Purchasing & Reimbursement (Composites)
Revision	F
Status	Draft, pending Lead signature (re-verify tiers/names each fall)
Effective date	2026-08-29
Supersedes	Purchasing-by-osmosis

Approvals

Role	Name	Date
Author	Simon Starbuck (drafted with Claude, SN6 Resources)	2026-07-12
Reviewer	simon (reviewer agent)	
Approver (Composites Lead)		

Revision history

Rev	Date	Author	Description of change
A	2026-07-12	Claude	Initial outline, documents the team-wide process as pinned in #purchasing (2025-10-26) + composites-specific rules
B	2026-07-28	Claude	Language pass: fewer em dashes for rhythm variety, no content change.
C	2026-08-03	Claude	New §7.8: the label printer as a standing purchase request, with the payback argument and why the cheaper and dearer options were both rejected (CS-001 §5).
D	2026-08-28	Claude	Engineering pass (CS-000 Rev C conventions). §7.2's single-sentence reimbursement rule became five checkable steps, which is the form a purchaser at midnight actually follows. No rule changed.

Rev	Date	Author	Description of change
E	2026-08-29	Claude	Removed §7.8's "Why not more" paragraph at Simon Starbuck's request: the standard no longer rules printer types in or out, it just states the request and its justification.
F	2026-08-29	Claude	Removed §7.8's "Model choice" paragraph too, same request: the item line already names the model, and the standard keeps no argument against alternatives.

1. Purpose

In SN5 basically all of our ~$5.3k spend went through the lead's personal card, reimbursements were slow, and needs that surfaced late turned into rush-shipping blowouts ($400 of shipping on $120 of ACP rods, PP-08). The team-wide purchasing process actually exists and is fine; composites members just didn't know it. This doc restates it and adds our ordering calendar.

2. Scope

All composites purchases and reimbursements; sponsor material requests at outline level.

3. References

Ref	Document	Where
R1	Team purchasing rules (Shailen Kumar, pinned in #purchasing, 2025-10-26)	Slack; re-verify tiers/names each fall
R2	PP-02, PP-08 RCAs	FEB-COMP-PP-001
R3	CS-011 (min-stock triggers)	CS-011

4. Definitions

Approval tiers, reimbursement form (pinned in #purchasing channel description), purchaser (a member who fronts money and gets reimbursed).

5. Equipment & Materials

None; process standard.

6. Safety

No physical hazards. Financial safety rule: nobody fronts more than they are comfortable waiting ~a month to get back (R1: deposits take up to a month).

7. Procedure (names/tiers as of 2025-26; re-verify each season)

7.1 Approval

1. **Every purchase gets approval BEFORE buying**, posted in #purchasing: <$50 → subteam lead; $50–250 → division lead; >$250 → President/VP (R1).

7.2 Reimbursement

1. Photograph the **itemized receipt**. A card statement alone is not enough.
2. Add the card statement: redact other lines, keep name, address, last-4, the purchase and the date.
3. Amazon orders: the order must show Shipped or Delivered before submitting.
4. Submit the pinned form within **1 month** of purchase. No Venmo, Zelle, cash or gift cards.
5. Categorize under the subteam **using** the material, not the one buying it (R1).

7.3 Distributed purchasers

1. The lead designates 2–3 members (with the finance lead's knowledge) as regular purchasers so no single card is the team's float (PP-08).

7.4 Order calendar (composites)

1. **Order calendar:** September, bulk consumables + first Easy Composites basket (6-week lead, customs margin, PP-02); December, spring-semester basket; rolling, min-stock triggers from CS-011 stock walks. A shared "basket" doc collects wants before each EC order (SN5 practice: "add what you would like by TONIGHT"; make it a standing doc instead).

7.5 Rush orders

1. Any order with >2× shipping-to-item ratio needs the lead's explicit sign-off with the alternative (wait/borrow/local) stated. Make the $400-shipping decision consciously.

7.6 Sponsor asks

1. **Sponsor asks:** batch material requests through the lead (Airtech/Sigmatex/Coastal/ACP/Rexco contacts live with PM); never let sponsor stock run to zero before asking, since sponsors have lead times too.

7.7 Season close

1. All reimbursements submitted by the finance deadline (SN5: July 4 hard cutoff; unpaid-form escalation window to July 14; dates change yearly, check #purchasing).

7.8 Standing request: label printer

Filed here rather than left implicit, because CS-001 Rev C's §5 stops being self-funding at exactly one line item.

Item	Brother PT-D610BT label printer, plus 3 × TZe-251 24 mm laminated tape and 1 × TZe-231 12 mm
Cost	~$115 hardware, ~$76 tape. Year one $191; recurring $50/yr at a measured ~480 labels per season
Requested by	Composites

Justification. The shop's current identification method is handwriting on tape, and a standard Sharpie is soluble in the isopropyl alcohol used at every stage of CS-004 and CS-009. So the labels the team already

relies on are being erased by the team's own cleaning step. A single mis-identified 8-ply carbon part costs roughly $300–600 in fabric and resin plus about 20 person-hours to remake, and a mis-identified mold costs a machining slot at RFS. Payback is one prevented mix-up.

Why not cheaper. The zero-cost path (Avery sheets on the office laser with a packing-tape overlaminate, CS-001 §7.8) is retained as the documented fallback, not eliminated. It works; it is just slower per label and one grade less durable.

8. Quality checks / acceptance criteria

Check	Target	Method	Record where
Pre-approval on every purchase	100%	#purchasing thread exists	Slack
Reimbursements in 1 month	100%	Purchaser self-check	Form records
No unplanned rush shipping	Lead sign-off recorded when it happens	#purchasing thread	Slack

9. Records

#purchasing threads + the Budget sheet (kept as the season's spend view; the WO BOM fields give per-part material cost).